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Acacia nilotica, *Albizia lebbeck*, *Mimosa pudica* (sensitive plant).

Torus contains two types of florets: 1. Disc floret or tubular floret. 2. Ray floret or ligulate floret.

The flower and inflorescence are subtended by a lateral appendage called bract. In sunflower, you may notice that the whorl of bracts forms a cup like structure beneath mimicking the calyx. Such whorl of bracts is called involucre. A group of bracts present beneath the sub unit of inflorescence is known as Involucel.

Heads are classified into two types.

i. Homogamous head: This type of inflorescence exhibits single kind of florets. Inflorescence has disc florets alone. Example: *Vernonia, Ageratum* or Ray florets alone. Example: *Launaea, Sonchus*.



Figure 4.4: Homogamous head
(v) disc floret, **(w)** ray floret

ii. Heterogamous head: The inflorescence possesses both types of florets. Example: *Helianthus, Tridax*.

Disc florets at the centre of the head are tubular and bisexual whereas the **ray florets** found at the margin of the head which are ligulate pistilate (unisexual).

II. Cymose inflorescence.

Central axis stops growing and ends in a flower, further growth is by means of axillary buds. Old flowers present at apex and young flowers at base

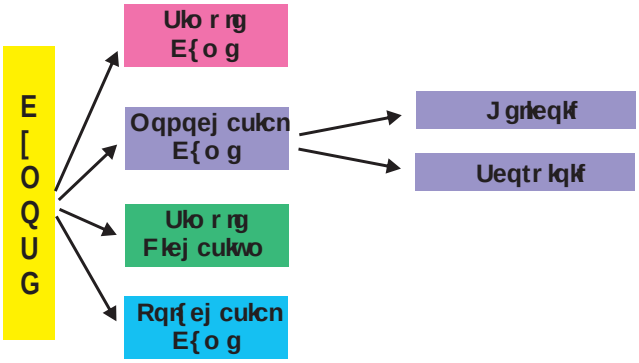


Figure 4.5: Cyme

1. Simple cyme (solitary): Determinate inflorescence consists of a single flower. It may be terminal or axillary. Example: terminal in *Trillium grandiflorum* and axillary in *Hibiscus*.



Figure 4.6: (a) Simple cyme

2. Monochasial Cyme (uniparous): The main axis ends with a flower. From two lateral bracts, only one branch grows further. It may be **helicoid (bostryx)** or **Scorpioid (cincinnus).**

a. Helicoid: Axis develops on only one side and forms a coil structure atleast at the earlier development stage. Example: *Hamelia*, potato.